Certified RDE Certification - Candidate Job Aid

Certification Process Overview

The Certified RDE certification follows a five-stage process:

1. **Registration** - You are nominated/invited and register for the program
2. **Application** - You complete self-assessment form and AI project, submit for review
3. **Application Review** - Assigned reviewer from global council evaluates your submission
4. **Interview** - You complete interview with council member
5. **Certification** - You get certified as Certified AI Engineer

Your Journey Through Certification

Part 1: Complete the Questionnaire

Step 1: Access the Application

- Use the link provided in your registration email
- The link will open a Power App

Step 2: Start Your Application

- Click "Start Application"
- Click "Continue"

Step 3: Complete the Questionnaire

- Work through all questions in the form
- Use "Next" and "Prev" buttons to navigate between sections
- The form automatically saves every 10 seconds
- You don't need to finish in one session - you can save, close your browser, and return later to complete
- When finished, click "Submit"

Part 2: Complete the Code Challenge

Step 1: Follow the Instructions

- Refer to the instructions provided in the appendix or attachment you received
- Complete the code challenge according to those specifications

Step 2: Submit Your Code

- Zip your completed code
- Share the zip file via OneDrive with the RDE Certification Operations team

Part 3: Application Review

After submission:

- A reviewer will evaluate your questionnaire responses and code
- **If recommended to proceed:** You'll be contacted by an interviewer within one week to schedule an interview
- **If not recommended:** The ops team will notify you with feedback and next steps

Part 4: Interview

Scheduling:

- The interviewer will reach out to schedule a one-hour interview at a mutually convenient time

What to Expect:

- Questions about your questionnaire responses
- Discussion about your code implementation and approach
- Questions on AI engineering fundamentals, cloud platforms, software engineering practices, and related topics
- Be prepared to explain your reasoning and demonstrate your understanding

Part 5: Results

Timeline:

- You'll be notified of your results within one week after the interview
- Contact the ops team if you have any questions

Questions? Contact the RDE Certification Operations team via email.

Appendix

Part 2: Hands-On Project

Project Theme: Building Practical AI-Enhanced Engineering Solutions

Candidate Goal

Build and demonstrate a working AI-powered solution that addresses a common engineering challenge, showing practical application of AI tools and best practices.

Sample Project: Smart Backlog Assistant

Objective: Build an AI-assisted tool that helps organize and structure engineering work by:

- Processing meeting notes or requirement documents (text or PDF)
- Analyzing existing backlog items (JSON file or simple integration)
- Generating structured outputs like user stories or task lists

Output:

- Well-formatted user stories with clear descriptions
- Basic acceptance criteria
- Suggested priority or categorization
- Summary of key requirements identified

Constraints:

- Use at least one AI API or framework (OpenAI, Anthropic, Hugging Face, etc.)
- Include basic error handling
- Demonstrate practical prompt engineering
- Show how AI was used in your development process

Required Steps

1. Problem Definition

- Clearly describe the problem you're solving
- Identify 2-3 specific use cases
- Document any AI tools you used to help refine your problem statement (optional but encouraged)

2. Solution Design

- Create a simple architecture diagram showing:
    - Main components of your solution

- How data flows through the system
    - Where AI is used
- Document your approach to prompt design
- Include any AI assistance used in design phase

3. Testing Approach

- Create 2-3 sample inputs that represent realistic scenarios
- Define what "good output" looks like for each sample
- Manually verify your solution produces reasonable results

4. Implementation

- Working code that demonstrates core functionality
- Clear README with setup instructions
- At least one AI integration (API call, model usage, etc.)
- Basic logging or output that shows the process
- Comments explaining key decisions

5. Documentation

- Brief summary of your approach
- Examples of prompts used and why
- Description of how you tested the solution
- Reflection on what worked well and what you'd improve

Evaluation Criteria:

- Does the solution work and solve the stated problem?
- Is the code readable and reasonably well-structured?
- Are AI capabilities used effectively?
- Is there evidence of thoughtful prompt engineering?
- Can the solution be run and tested by reviewers?

Scope Guidance:

- Focus on demonstrating understanding rather than building production-ready systems
- A well-executed simple solution is better than an incomplete complex one
- Aim for 200-500 lines of code (not including dependencies)
- Should be completable in 8-12 hours of focused work

Tips for Success:

- Start simple and get something working first

- Document your AI usage throughout (prompts, tools, iterations)
- Test with realistic examples
- Ask for clarification if project requirements are unclear
- Show your problem-solving process, not just the final result